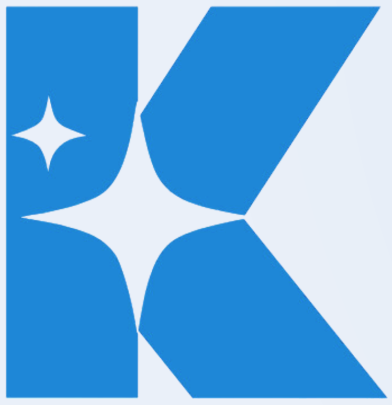




PROMPT PLAYBOOK

Vague prompt, vague answer. Here is the six-part fix

Why ChatGPT, Claude and Gemini give you waffle, and the checklist we use to get a usable answer first time.

[SWIPE >>](#)



01 / 06

Say the job and who it is for

"Write something about our offer" gives the AI nothing to aim at. "Write a 90-word email to existing customers announcing our winter booking slots" does. Name the task, the reader and the length.

START WITH

Rewrite your last prompt so a stranger could tell who reads the result.



02 / 06

Give it the context it cannot guess

The AI knows nothing about your business unless you say. Anthropic's guide says to treat it like a capable new starter with no background. Two lines on what you sell, where, and to whom change the whole answer.

START WITH

Save a two-line business description and paste it at the top of every prompt.



03 / 06

Say what a good answer looks like

OpenAI's current guidance asks for the outcome and success criteria up front: friendly but not chatty, under 100 words, one clear next step. Without a bar to hit, the AI picks its own.

START WITH

Add one line starting "A good answer will..." to your next prompt.



04 / 06

Show it one example

Paste a reply you were happy with and say "match this tone". One good example often beats a paragraph of description. The trade-off: it may copy the example too closely, so use a real one but vary it.

START WITH

Find your best past email or post and paste it in as the model.



05 / 06

Ask for the format you will actually use

A table you can paste into a spreadsheet, three subject lines, a numbered checklist. If you do not say, you get an essay. Ask for the shape, not just the content.

START WITH

End your next prompt with "Give me this as ..." and name the format.



06 / 06

Give it a way out, then check the facts

Add "if you are not sure, say so instead of guessing". Models will still sometimes state wrong things confidently, so check prices, dates and legal points yourself before anything goes to a customer.

START WITH

Check one figure in your last AI answer against a real source today.



Brief it like a new starter.

This is the checklist we would hand a client: the job, the context, the bar, an example, the format and an escape hatch.

Which task do you keep re-prompting because the first answer is never quite right?